



2E-EDUC 3- Principles and Methods of Teaching

WORKSHEET – My Guiding Psychological Principles for Effective Teaching

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Direction:

Below are important and useful psychological principles teachers ought to be aware of from the Coalition for Psychology for Schools and Education.

A. How Do Students Think and Learn

- #1. Students' beliefs or perceptions about intelligence and ability affect their cognitive functioning and learning.
- #2. What students already know affects their learning
- #3. Students' cognitive development and learning are not limited by general stages of development.
- #4. Learning is based on content, so generalizing learning to new contexts is not spontaneous but instead needs to be facilitated.
- #5. Acquiring long-term knowledge and skills is largely dependent on practice.
- #6. Clear, explanatory, and timely feedback to students is important for learning.
- #7. Students' self-regulation assists learning, and self-regulatory skills can be taught.
- #8. Student creativity can be fostered.

B. What Motivates Students?

- #9. Students tend to enjoy learning and perform better when they are more intrinsically than extrinsically motivated to achieve.
- #10. Students persist in the face of challenging tasks and process information more deeply when they adopt mastery goals rather than performance goals.
- #11. Teachers' expectations about their students affect students' opportunities to learn, their motivation, and their learning outcomes.
- #12. Setting goals that are short term (proximal), specific, and moderately challenging enhances motivation more than establishing goals that are long term (distal), general, and overly challenging.

C. Why Are Social Context, Interpersonal Relationships and Emotional Well-being Important to Student Learning?

- #13. Learning is situated with multiple social contexts.
- #14. Interpersonal relationships and communication are critical to both the teaching-learning process and the social-emotional development of students.
- #15. Emotional well-being influences educational performance, learning, and development.

D. How Can the Classroom Best Be Managed?

- #16. Expectations for classroom conduct and social interaction are learned and can be taught using proven principles of behavior and effective classroom instruction.
- #17. Effective classroom management is based on (a) setting and communicating high expectations, (b) consistently nurturing positive relationships, and (c) providing a high level of student support.

E. How to Assess Student Progress?

- #18. Formative and summative assessments are both important and useful but require different approaches and interpretations.
- #19. Students' skills, knowledge, and abilities are best measured with assessment processes grounded in psychological science with well-defined standards for quality and fairness.
- #20. Making sense of assessment data depends on clear, appropriate and fair interpretation



Questions for Reflections:

- I. Which of the above principles are you practicing now or intend to practice in the future? Please copy the number and the principle and explain by citing educational settings or teaching-learning situations.**

A. How Do Students Think and Learn

- #1. Students' beliefs or perceptions about intelligence and ability affect their cognitive functioning and learning.
- #2. What students already know affects their learning.
- #3. Students' cognitive development and learning are not limited by general stages of development.

Since ability is something the mind builds rather than a fixed amount a child is born with, these three principles sit at the center of how I teach. They grow from the cognitivist view of learning, and I have watched that view prove itself in a real classroom. One learner his classmates had already written off as slow turned out to hold the understanding all along, waiting only for someone to expect it of him. Ever since, I have refused to let a child accept too early the quiet verdict that they cannot do the work, and I make a point of showing learners the tasks they have already outgrown so they can watch their own thinking move forward. New lessons, too, I anchor in what learners carry from home and in their first language, which is Vygotsky's reminder that fresh knowledge has to fasten onto knowledge already there. Honesty forces one admission, though. Telling a child they can grow is close to empty if I withhold the support and the plain feedback that turn the promise into something real, so belief in ability only earns its keep when help arrives beside it.

B. What Motivates Students?

- #9. Students tend to enjoy learning and perform better when they are more intrinsically than extrinsically motivated to achieve.
- #11. Teachers' expectations about their students affect students' opportunities to learn, their motivation, and their learning outcomes.
- #12. Setting goals that are short term (proximal), specific, and moderately challenging enhances motivation more than establishing goals that are long term (distal), general, and overly challenging.

The principle about teacher expectations weighs on me most, because it names a quiet power that is easy to hold and easy to misuse. What a teacher expects has a measured effect on what a learner achieves, and those expectations tend to track a child's social class or the street they come from, so the psychological and the social sit tangled together here. I know the weight of this from my own side of the desk, since a teacher once expected something of me before I could expect it of myself, and it turned my whole direction. That memory is why I hold the firmest hopes for exactly the learners a system is quickest to pass over, and why I hand them short, reachable goals and real choices instead of steering by grades or fear. One truth keeps me watchful. The same expectation that lifts a learner can just as quietly flatten one, since a teacher who looks for little usually finds little, which makes this less a method to apply than a daily habit of checking my own assumptions before they harden into judgments.



C. Why Are Social Context, Interpersonal Relationships, and Emotional Well-being Important to Student Learning?

#13. Learning is situated with multiple social contexts.

#14. Interpersonal relationships and communication are critical to both the teaching-learning process and the social-emotional development of students.

#15. Emotional well-being influences educational performance, learning, and development.

Since no lesson ever unfolds in a sealed room, these three principles carry my strongest agreement. They draw on both the social and the humanistic ways of seeing a learner, on the idea that knowing is a shared act and on Maslow's lesson that a mind cannot climb toward ideas while its need for safety and calm goes unmet. Every child I teach also belongs to a family and a set of troubles that walk into the room with them, and compassion has to become something practical at that point. When a usually willing student goes quiet, I have trained myself to understand before I correct, because a hungry or frightened child cannot reach for a lesson while carrying a weight nobody has noticed. Making the room a place where the shy and the discouraged feel they belong is part of the teaching, not a pause from it. Real conditions, though, punish this principle hardest. Facing forty or more learners and a lesson that has to be finished, truly knowing each one slips out of reach, and that gap between what the principle asks and what the timetable allows is something no honest teacher can pretend away.

D. How Can the Classroom Best Be Managed?

#16. Expectations for classroom conduct and social interaction are learned and can be taught using proven principles of behavior and effective classroom instruction.

#17. Effective classroom management is based on (a) setting and communicating high expectations, (b) consistently nurturing positive relationships, and (c) providing a high level of student support.

Where order in the room is concerned, I lean on these two while holding them in a careful balance. Principle #16 comes straight from behaviorism, the reminder that good conduct is learned through clear expectations and steady reinforcement rather than simply barked as a demand. Yet I soften that behaviorist reflex with a humanistic and existentialist conviction that discipline ought to shape a free and self-aware person and not merely a quiet one, which is why #17 is the ground I stand on. Instead of governing by fear, I govern through the relationship itself, keeping the room safe enough that learners will risk the honest mistakes real learning demands. Once learners have a hand in shaping the rules they are asked to keep, management stops being about control and becomes a shared agreement about how a group lives well together. The tension I cannot dodge is that this kind of management is slow to build, and a beginning teacher staring down a hard class feels the pull of fear because fear works faster. Trust is the better road and also the steeper one, and saying otherwise to a new teacher would be a kindness that misleads.

E. How to Assess Student Progress?

#18. Formative and summative assessments are both important and useful but require different approaches and interpretations.



#19. Students' skills, knowledge, and abilities are best measured with assessment processes grounded in psychological science with well-defined standards for quality and fairness. #6. Clear, explanatory, and timely feedback to students is important for learning.

#20. Making sense of assessment data depends on clear, appropriate and fair interpretation

Rooted as it is in a concern for justice, my approach to assessment starts from principle #19, which puts the value plainly. A test must never dock a learner for a disadvantage that has nothing to do with the skill in question, whether that is a home with no books or a language the exam takes for granted while the child is still learning it. This ties straight into the history and policy of Philippine schooling, where newer reforms are turning away from ranking children and toward describing what each one can honestly do. My weight falls on formative work, using the quick feedback of principle #6 to steer learning while there is still room to change course rather than waiting to pass sentence at the end. What most people miss is that a test quietly announces whatever a teacher truly prizes. Claim to want critical thinking but measure only memory, and learners will chase memory, so unless my assessment mirrors my aims it will silently cancel them out.

2. Over-all, what does this activity mean to you as a practicing/future teacher in relation to teaching-learning process particularly in promoting learner responsibility and achievement?

I believe that this activity turns broad convictions into concrete practice and settles an old argument for me, whether good teaching is instinct or method, by showing that it is the marriage of the two. Every principle here stands on a foundation I have studied, philosophical or psychological, social or historical, and together they lend reasoned backing to beliefs I already carried. Read as a single body of thought, they all point in a single direction: toward learners who shoulder their own growth and achieve genuine success. A child who trusts that ability can grow, who feels safe and known, and who is judged fairly is slowly becoming the author of their own schooling, and that authorship is exactly what I am teaching toward. From existentialism, I take the wish to free each learner to define who they are rather than be defined by poverty or by someone's low estimate of them. From cognitivism and social reconstructionism, I take the wish to raise the overlooked and, through them, to build a fairer country. Clearest of all is this, that the twenty principles are not a checklist to perform but a standard to be measured against, and the true difficulty is living up to them steadily when the class is large, the clock is unkind, and no one at all is watching.

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